

Rash or Redness - Widespread - Male (Child)

Algorithm 1251 | Child (0-17 years) | Gender at birth: Male

Definition

- Widespread rash or redness assessment decomposed from NHS.UK's published emergency rash guidance.
- Child patient.
- Male.

Initial assessment

1. [DURATION] How long has the rash been present?
2. [OPEN_TEXT] What is the person's exact age and sex, are they pregnant/breastfeeding or immunocompromised, and was there a new medicine, food, product, bite/sting, infection, or close contact?
3. [YES_NO] Any fever or feeling generally unwell?
4. [CAREGIVER_OBSERVATION] What has a safe parent or caregiver observed about alertness, breathing, pain, swelling, fever, eating or drinking, sleep, play, and normal activity?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Anaphylaxis

Are throat or tongue swelling, breathing difficulty, faintness, confusion, or collapse the main concern?

Systemic allergic-reaction features require the Anaphylaxis pathway.

1. Disposition level 100

Is there sudden swelling of the lips, mouth, throat, or tongue, difficulty breathing, or does the rash look like small bruises or bleeding under the skin that does not fade when pressed with a glass?

NHS.UK rash guidance lists sudden allergic-reaction swelling/breathing difficulty and a non-fading rash as emergency criteria.

1. Disposition level 70

Is the rash spreading, accompanied by fever, or is the cause unclear and concerning?

A spreading rash with fever, or an unexplained cause, warrants primary-care review to identify the underlying condition.

1. Disposition level 15

Is this a mild, non-spreading rash with none of the features above?

NHS.UK guidance provides general skin self-care measures for a mild rash.

Advice

Qatar emergency widespread-rash response

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not drive. If anaphylaxis is suspected, use the person's prescribed adrenaline auto-injector immediately according to its instructions and emergency plan; do not substitute antihistamine for adrenaline. Keep the person lying flat unless breathing is easier sitting up or they are vomiting; a pregnant person should lie on the left side. If unresponsive and not breathing normally, start age-appropriate CPR as directed by 999. A non-fading rash or serious illness also needs 999 even without allergy symptoms. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: airway swelling or breathing difficulty; faintness, confusion, floppiness, or loss of consciousness; non-fading rash; rapidly worsening illness.

Urgent widespread-rash review

- Arrange same-day in-person review through the Qatar route approved by governance, with a lower threshold for infants, pregnancy, immunocompromise, new medicines, fever, pain, blistering/peeling, or mouth/eye/genital involvement.
- Call Back If: rash worsens or spreads further; fever, blistering, peeling, or mucosal involvement develops.

Governed care for a mild rash

- Avoid a suspected trigger, use a bland unperfumed moisturiser, and wear loose clothing. Antihistamine selection and dose require age, weight, pregnancy/breastfeeding, comorbidity, sedation risk, and current-medicine checks under the approved Qatar pathway. Call 999 for airway swelling, breathing difficulty, faintness, floppiness, or a non-fading rash.
- Call Back If: rash spreads or worsens; fever or systemic illness develops; mouth, eye, or genital involvement.

First aid

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not drive. If anaphylaxis is suspected, use the person's prescribed adrenaline auto-injector immediately according to its instructions and emergency plan; do not substitute antihistamine for adrenaline. Keep the person lying flat unless breathing is easier sitting up or they are vomiting; a pregnant person should lie on the left side. If unresponsive and not breathing normally, start age-appropriate CPR as directed by 999. A non-fading rash or serious illness also needs 999 even without allergy symptoms. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

References

- NHS.UK, "Skin rash in children" (rash emergency warning signs), <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/skin-rash-children/> (page last reviewed 03 October 2024)

Provenance

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